

# PLSC 197 / SODA 110N: Social Data, Technology, and Artificial Intelligence

## Assignment 2: Platform Data Audit

### Assignment

In this week's assignment, you'll conduct an "audit" of your own data on a single platform. The assignment is straightforward:

1. Choose one digital platform you use regularly. Be creative; Instagram and TikTok are fine, but try to get outside the box a bit.
2. Write a report, containing the following sections:
  - **My Data:** Describe the kinds of data the platform (definitely, likely) collects about you.
  - **Platform Effects:** Briefly discuss if and how the platform's data collection shapes your behavior on that platform.
  - **Data Usage:** Describe how the platform itself *uses* the data it collects on you.
  - **Commodification:** Research and outline what other entities (other platforms, businesses, government, etc.) receive or purchase your data from that platform, if any. Talk about what entities *might* want that data, and why.
  - **Selection:** Describe one or two ways in which your own data are used reciprocally to shape *your* experience on the platform.

### Details

Your assignment should include a separate title page with your name, the name of the course, the name of the assignment, and the date on which it was completed / submitted. The body of the written assignment should be *double-spaced*, in a conventionally-sized (10 to 12 point) font. Each part of the assignment should be as short or long as you deem necessary; a rough target might be a total of 4-5 pages. You need not cite any sources for this assignment, or include references, unless you choose to.

This assignment must be completed and submitted by Friday, September 25, 2026 at 11:59 p.m. ET. Submit your assignment by *creating / converting your assignment into PDF format*, and emailing it to Dr. Zorn (at [zorn@psu.edu](mailto:zorn@psu.edu)). Assignments received after the due date will not be accepted.

This assignment is worth a possible 100 points.